Unequal Visibility of AI Futures for Education in Vietnamese News

Vu Nguyen Quang Duy

Abstract

News coverage presents multiple futures for artificial intelligence (AI) in education, but gives them unequal visibility. This study examines 828 articles from 20 Vietnamese news outlets using the Sociotechnical Imaginaries in Public Communication framework. Five future roles organise the analysis, with evaluations, speakers, reasons, and proposed actions linked within attributed accounts and compared at article level. AI as a Learning Partner appeared in 60.5% of articles and AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative in 53.0%, ahead of Educational Judgment (37.7%), National Development (19.6%), and Educational Management (10.3%). Public/central outlets gave greater attention to AI Literacy and National Development than commercial/general outlets, alongside more frequent public-authority voices and proposals for curriculum and resources. Learning Partner and Educational Judgment had similar overall visibility across the groups, but their evaluations differed: negative assessments of Educational Judgment appeared in 49.7% of commercial/general articles containing that role, compared with 28.8% of public/central articles. Across the corpus, desirable futures appeared in 96.0% of articles and undesirable futures in 33.1%. Close reading shows that warnings could support both restrictions and proposals for responsible AI use. The central pattern is an uneven distribution of attention within a shared set of educational futures: institutional preparation receives greater emphasis in public/central coverage, while commercial/general coverage gives more space to problems of educational judgment. These differences show which futures gain public visibility and institutional justification, and where their terms remain contested.

Introduction

AI is expected to personalise learning, change assessment, simplify educational administration, and prepare people for new forms of work. These futures can reinforce one another, but they make different demands on education. A system that helps students finish tasks faster may also reduce the effort through which they learn. A tool introduced to protect academic integrity may place greater authority in an automated judgment. The question is therefore not simply whether AI is welcomed, but which educational futures are advanced through it and which receive sustained attention.

Imagined futures matter because they help organise present choices. They give reasons to invest, revise curricula, develop infrastructure, and assign responsibilities. Sociotechnical imaginaries connect such technological expectations to visions of social order and collective life (Jasanoff & Kim, 2009; Jasanoff & Kim, 2015). Their plurality does not imply equal influence: some acquire institutional backing and resources, while others remain proposals, qualifications, or objections. Studies of

national AI strategies show how governments connect technological development to public purposes and make particular directions actionable (Bareis & Katzenbach, 2022). Education is central to this process, both as a field to be transformed and as a means of preparing people for the anticipated future (Rahm, 2023).

Policy documents make formally endorsed directions visible. News offers another view of the same process, bringing official programmes into contact with commercial promises, expert judgments, and accounts of educational experience. It is a space in which futures are publicly articulated, repeated, justified, and questioned (Brause et al., 2024; Brause et al., 2025). Examining this space reveals both the range of futures in circulation and the unequal attention given to them. Connecting an envisioned role for AI to its speakers, evaluations, reasons, and recommended actions makes that inequality more informative than a general measure of optimism.

Vietnam provides a setting in which educational and national ambitions are closely connected. Its 2021 national AI strategy and 2022 education digital-transformation programme position education as both a site of technological application and a source of future capabilities (Prime Minister of Vietnam, 2021, 2022). Research on five major Vietnamese state newspapers during 2016–2022 found optimistic AI narratives, national-development aspirations, substantial industry participation, and limited discussion of ethical issues (Nguyen et al., 2026). An education-specific analysis can show how these broad aspirations take shape in proposals for learning, assessment, institutional management, and AI-related preparation.

Differences within Vietnamese news are equally relevant. Party-state oversight and commercial pressures coexist, while outlets differ in institutional affiliation, publishing orientation, and audience (Luong, 2022; Nguyen-Thu, 2019). Comparing public/central and commercial/general outlets therefore allows attention to variation within a shared media environment. The issue is which futures and voices receive greater attention in each group, including where similar aspirations coexist with different evaluations.

This study examines 828 articles from 20 outlets using the Sociotechnical Imaginaries in Public Communication (SIPC) framework. Five future roles organise the analysis; the remaining fields establish how each role is evaluated, justified, and connected to action. Two questions guide the study:

> RQ1. Which futures for AI and education are articulated in Vietnamese news, how are they constructed, and which are most prevalent?
>
> RQ2. How do the visibility and construction of these futures differ between public/central and commercial/general outlets?

The central finding is an uneven distribution of attention within a shared set of educational futures.

Learning support and preparation for an AI-oriented world lead the coverage. Public/central outlets give greater attention to institutional preparation and collective development, while commercial/general outlets more frequently include negative assessments of educational judgment. The contribution lies in these differences in emphasis and construction, rather than in the novelty of the five roles themselves.

Literature Review

Educational purposes in sociotechnical imaginaries of AI

Sociotechnical imaginaries are collectively held visions of desirable futures in which technological development is connected to ideas about social life and social order (Jasanoff & Kim, 2009; Jasanoff & Kim, 2015). Their significance lies in how they guide present choices: which problems deserve attention, which technologies merit investment, and which institutions should act. National AI strategies, for example, connect technological capabilities to ambitions for economic development and international standing, helping justify programmes and allocate responsibilities (Bareis & Katzenbach, 2022). Studying imaginaries therefore involves examining the social commitments carried by technological promises, including whose expectations gain institutional support (Hendriks et al., 2025).

Education occupies two positions in these futures. It is expected to benefit from new technologies and to prepare people for the society those technologies are expected to produce. Rahm (2023) shows how expectations of technological change become demands for education, skills, and particular forms of citizenship. These demands depend on how the problem is defined. If the problem is a shortage of technical skills, the proposed response may be curriculum reform. If it is students' dependence on automated assistance, the response may involve limits on use or changes to assessment. Rahm & Rahm-Skågeby (2023) argue that educational AI proposals contain such problem definitions, which shape what becomes a reasonable or necessary intervention.

Research identifies several purposes behind these proposals. Nemorin et al. (2023) connect educational AI discourse to economic development, geopolitical competition, and market expansion. Other work examines promises of wider access and changes to teachers' work, showing how expected benefits depend on resources, institutional support, and pedagogical relationships (Bulathwela et al., 2021; Hrastinski et al., 2019). Critiques of efficiency and performance also ask what these priorities leave out. An approach that values faster completion or measurable achievement may give less attention to care, curiosity, critical judgment, or the experience of learning itself (Mamlok, 2025; Wieczorek & Romele, 2026). These studies make educational purpose central to the analysis: the significance of an AI application depends on what it is expected to improve and how improvement is judged.

The relationship among these purposes remains an empirical question. Saving teachers' time may be justified as a way to provide more individual attention, linking efficiency to care. Developing AI skills may serve both professional preparation and national economic ambitions. Yet the same purposes can also support different approaches. Protecting independent thought might justify teaching students to question AI outputs or restricting their access to them. Research on educational imaginaries shows that competing understandings of improvement can coexist within the same policy setting (Linderoth et al., 2024). Analysis must therefore examine how purposes are connected to practices and responsibilities, rather than treating personalisation, efficiency, or skills development as self-explanatory visions.

Warnings also help define desired futures. Concerns about dependence, inequality, or the loss of human capabilities can establish conditions under which a technology becomes acceptable (Cave & Dihal, 2019). A call to limit AI use may seek to protect an educational goal that advocates of adoption also value. Positive and negative evaluations consequently need to be read in relation to their targets: what is being welcomed or feared, whose interests are at stake, and what response is proposed.

Public communication and the analysis of educational futures

News media make technological expectations publicly available through decisions about what to cover, whom to quote, and how to describe anticipated change. Their coverage brings official programmes into contact with commercial claims, expert judgments, and accounts of everyday experience (Brause et al., 2025). Studies of AI reporting show that these expectations vary across national settings, where technological benefits and risks become connected to different political priorities and institutional arrangements (Brause et al., 2024; Wang et al., 2025). Variation also occurs within a polity: government, business, academic, and civic actors may advance different expectations about AI (Richter et al., 2025).

Access to this public discussion is uneven. Some actors appear as authorities entitled to explain technological change, while others appear mainly as people who will experience its consequences. Research on educational AI reporting identifies imbalances in actor representation that can favour institutional priorities over educators' and learners' concerns (Huang & Gadavanij, 2025). This distinction matters when asking whose future is being described. An article may repeatedly discuss benefits for students without including students' judgments about those benefits. Likewise, teachers may be assigned responsibility for successful implementation without being given comparable scope to define its purposes. Attention to voice must therefore distinguish speaking about a future, being affected by it, and being expected to deliver it.

The Sociotechnical Imaginaries in Public Communication (SIPC) framework provides a way to

examine these distinctions systematically. It treats publicly communicated futures as visions of desirable or undesirable technological change that can orient action towards their realisation or prevention (Brause et al., 2025). Its six dimensions cover vision, desirability, futures, technological object, speaker, and implications. These are operationalised through twelve fields, shown in Table 1.

Table 1: SIPC dimensions and the questions used to examine educational AI futures. Adapted from Brause et al. (2025).

Theoretical dimension	Analytical field	Question guiding analysis
Vision	Future role	What educational or social change is expected, sought, or feared?
Vision	Certainty	How firmly is that outcome predicted?
Desirability	Desirability level	How does the speaker evaluate the anticipated change?
Desirability	Affected entities	Who is expected to experience its consequences?
Desirability	Rationale	What reasons or values support the evaluation?
Futures	Timespan	When is the change expected to occur?
Futures	Space	Where is it expected to apply?
Technological object	Technology characteristics	What form of AI is involved?
Technological object	Technology context	In what educational setting is it expected to operate?
Speaker	Speaker	Who articulates the future, and in what capacity?
Implications	Action recommendation	What action or restraint is proposed?
Implications	Action responsibility	Who is expected to act or be accountable?

The framework's value lies in connecting these fields. A forecast of improved learning means something different when improvement refers to higher test scores, stronger independent judgment, or wider participation. Its meaning also depends on whether the proposed change is justified by a provider, a teacher, or a learner, and whether it requires new products, different teaching

practices, or restrictions on use. Counting each element separately can show what receives attention. Reconstructing their connections shows the educational future being proposed.

Brause et al. (2024) organised their healthcare analysis around themes in AI's envisioned role, then examined the other analytical elements in relation to each role. This study follows that logic across a larger educational corpus. Future roles provide the organising categories; their evaluations, speakers, reasons, and implications establish how they are constructed. A role can contain both welcomed and feared developments, and similar evaluations can support different practices. Reading these connections preserves variation within a role without treating every favourable or critical statement as a separate imaginary.

News evidence also sets the scope of this interpretation. Public articulation is one part of the collective and institutional life of imaginaries; it does not establish that audiences accept a vision or that institutions have adopted it (Hendriks et al., 2025; Jasanoff & Kim, 2015). Repetition requires similar care. Several outlets may circulate the same announcement or quotation, increasing its visibility without adding independently expressed support. The analysis therefore treats recurrence as evidence of circulation and examines attribution and source context before interpreting agreement.

Educational AI futures in Vietnam's media context

Vietnam's national AI strategy and education digital-transformation programme assign education a role in technological development. They support AI applications in education while calling for the skills and specialist expertise needed to strengthen national capabilities (Prime Minister of Vietnam, 2021, 2022). Education consequently appears both as a public service to be improved and as a means of pursuing wider development goals. These policy commitments provide a reference point against which news accounts can promote applications, describe institutional initiatives, or question whether particular uses serve educational needs.

Such reporting takes place within a media environment shaped by party-state oversight and commercial pressures. Institutional supervision and editorial guidance influence permissible coverage, while advertising, sponsorship, and competition for audiences affect publishing priorities (Luong, 2022; Nguyen-Thu, 2019). These pressures coexist within outlets. Their institutional affiliations and publishing orientations nevertheless differ, providing a basis for examining variation in the actors and educational expectations they make visible.

Nguyen et al. (2026) found prevailing optimism and national-development aspirations in AI reporting by five major Vietnamese state newspapers during 2016–2022. They also identified substantial industry participation and limited attention to ethical issues. These findings suggest that developmental ambitions and commercial participation can occupy the same news space. An education-specific analysis can examine how that relationship is expressed through proposals for curricula,

teaching, assessment, and institutional investment. It can also ask whether concerns about learning and professional judgment qualify the terms on which technological expansion is supported.

The comparison between public/central and commercial/general outlets addresses this variation. The labels describe institutional profiles and publishing orientations within the same political environment. Public/central outlets may give greater attention to official programmes and collective responsibilities, while commercial/general outlets may foreground applications, products, and educational experiences. These are possibilities to investigate, not positions assigned to the groups in advance. Official and commercial actors can promote similar initiatives, and criticism of AI use can appeal to the same educational or national goals invoked by its advocates.

The analytical question is therefore how each group connects purposes to people and proposed action. Differences in the frequency of learner voices, for example, matter partly because learners may introduce concerns absent from institutional announcements. Similar support for professional preparation may conceal disagreement about whether competence requires greater AI use or protection from dependence. Examining these relationships allows the study to assess both variation across outlet groups and the educational commitments that cross their boundaries.

Methodology

Research design and corpus construction

This study combined qualitative analysis of educational AI futures with descriptive comparisons across Vietnamese news outlets. The Sociotechnical Imaginaries in Public Communication framework supplied six dimensions and twelve analytical fields. Categories within these fields were developed from the collected texts. Articles were the units of sampling and descriptive comparison. Within each article, attributed statements about educational futures were coded to retain connections among expected outcomes, evaluations, speakers, and proposed actions.

Articles were retrieved through Google News RSS searches targeting 21 Vietnamese outlet domains and publications dated between 2017 and 2026. Queries combined Vietnamese terms for AI and education with named technologies and terms concerning assessment and academic integrity. Search vocabulary was adapted across three periods: 2017–2021, 2022–2023, and 2024–2026. [**AUTHOR TO CONFIRM: collection dates, the final publication-date cutoff, and the basis for selecting the 21 domains.**] Duplicate search hits were consolidated, titles screened for relevance, and publisher URLs resolved before article texts and metadata were extracted. When initial extraction returned incomplete content, alternative retrieval procedures were used to recover the article. The collection procedure sought to retrieve all available matches across the specified queries and periods. Google News RSS nevertheless limits results per query, so this effort cannot establish ex-

haustive coverage of indexed or published news. The current project directory retains the retrieved corpus and validation/export scripts, but not the original crawling and scraping scripts.

Source adequacy and eligibility were assessed separately. Source checks identified missing article bodies, unrelated webpage content, and unavailable audiovisual transcripts. Where possible, incomplete texts were replaced with fuller versions of the same publication. Eligibility required an anticipated or normatively desired educational change involving AI. Reports of current applications qualified when they connected those applications to an expected educational outcome or direction. A reference to AI adoption, technical performance, university affiliation, or a course title alone was insufficient.

The working corpus contained 1,098 records. Verification of article–extraction linkages identified 15 records without recoverable original identifiers and two duplicate extraction records associated with one original identifier. These 17 records were excluded as storage and linkage errors. Of the 1,081 retained articles, 864 contained clear educational futures, 93 were borderline, 107 did not contain a supported educational future, and 17 remained unresolved because the source material was inadequate. The main analytical sample comprised 828 clear-future articles, excluding 36 for which the producing publisher was uncertain.

20 of the targeted outlets contributed retained articles; *khoahocphattrien.vn* contributed none. Outlets were classified as public/central or commercial/general according to institutional affiliation and publishing orientation (Table 2). Assignments were established independently of article tone and coding outcomes. The classification is deliberately approximate: institutional affiliation and commercial publishing practices can overlap within either group. These operational groups do not distinguish state ownership from private ownership or directly measure political and commercial influence. The main sample contained 424 public/central articles and 404 commercial/general articles.

Each retained article was linked to its original identifier, publication metadata, URL, source text, and text hash. Eligibility decisions and publisher-uncertainty flags were retained in the project dataset. Source materials, extraction and coding protocols, the final codebook, and validation and export scripts are retained in the project dataset. [**AUTHOR TO CONFIRM: repository or supplementary-materials link before submission.**]

Extraction and coding

AI-assisted open extraction first organised relevant material into the twelve SIPC fields, preserving attribution, qualifications, and conflicting evaluations. Attributed accounts then served as coding units within articles. An account could span several sentences and was distinguished by its speaker position, proposed arrangement, or evaluation target. This retained the connection between a

Table 2: Operational classification of outlets.

Outlet group	Count	Included domains
Public/central	11	baochinhphu.vn; giaoduc.net.vn; giaoducthoidai.vn; laodong.vn; nhandan.vn; qdnd.vn; tiasang.com.vn; vietnamnet.vn; vietnamplus.vn; vov.vn; vtv.vn
Commercial/general	9	24h.com.vn; cafef.vn; dantri.com.vn; kenh14.vn; thanhnien.vn; tuoitre.vn; vnexpress.net; vtcnews.vn; znews.vn

future claim and the reasons or actions attached to it.

The final five future-role categories were informed by the researcher's exploratory coding of 100 articles and subsequent review of the existing extraction and coding records. The revision applied these categories to the corpus while retaining eligibility decisions, account boundaries, and coding in the other eleven fields. Existing accounts and open extractions provided the starting point; source passages were revisited when a role or its target required clarification. A warning or implementation condition could inherit the role of a clearly identified programme, tool, or continuing attributed argument, but not another speaker's evaluation or intention. Accounts without a supported role remained unassigned.

The five categories are defined in Table 3. They describe the educational relationship or collective purpose being imagined, rather than its desirability. AI as a Learning Partner therefore includes accounts of impaired learning through dependence as well as accounts of useful assistance. Similarly, AI as a Force Reshaping Educational Judgment includes threats to authentic achievement and proposals to protect it. Multiple roles were permitted when an account explicitly supported more than one.

Table 3: Five future roles and their boundaries. Full inclusion and exclusion rules are retained in the codebook.

Future role	Analytical boundary
AI as a Learning Partner	Changes to learning, learner development, and relations among learners, teachers, and AI.
AI as a Force Reshaping Educational Judgment	Changes to assessment, academic integrity, authenticity, and recognition of achievement or competence.
AI as an Educational Management Tool	Changes to operations, administration, institutional services, monitoring, and resource allocation.
AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative	Preparing people to understand, develop, critically use, and live or work with AI.

Future role	Analytical boundary
AI as a Driver of National Development	AI-related education or university research serving an explicitly stated collective, sectoral, or national development purpose.

Desirability was coded separately for the relevant speaker and target. Positive and negative statements from different speakers, or about different arrangements, remained separate. Explicitly mixed evaluation required one speaker to weigh desirable and undesirable effects of the same arrangement. Unsupported fields remained missing. Consequently, positive and negative evaluations could coexist in an article without an explicitly mixed account, and a positively evaluated safeguard could express a critical response to AI use.

Source-linked evidence and automated checks supported traceability. Checks verified identifiers, permissible codes, record structure, and the location of evidence in retained source texts. These procedures did not constitute independent intercoder validation. The current analysis reports no verified agreement coefficient for the revised five-role coding. [**AUTHOR TO CONFIRM: model identifiers, run dates, configurations, and the documented division of researcher and AI work. Any independent reliability result must specify its sample, coders, fields, and applicability to this codebook before inclusion.**]

Descriptive comparison and interpretation

The article-level CSV defined the analytical sample and all main descriptive comparisons. Each code counted once per article, regardless of the number of accounts carrying it. Overall prevalence used 828 articles as its denominator; outlet comparisons used 424 public/central and 404 commercial/general articles. Missing fields remained in the denominator. Multiple codes were permitted, so percentages need not sum to 100%.

Profiles within each future role used the attributed-account records to preserve links that the article-level CSV alone cannot establish. A role and another field had to occur within the same account before the pair was counted. Each article then contributed at most once to each role–code pair. Percentages used the number of articles containing the role, within the full sample or the specified outlet group. Missing meant that no account bearing that role supplied a substantive code in the field. This approach measures the presence of a linked feature within a role; it does not imply that all features in a profile were expressed together by one speaker.

Desirability, rationale, speaker, action, and responsibility receive emphasis because they show how a future is valued, justified, and made actionable. The complete profiles retain certainty, affected

entities, technology, educational context, time, and space (Appendix A). No account was excluded from a role's profile because it lacked a rationale or action. The analysis does not rank multi-field combinations, which would favour accounts explicitly supplying every selected field and could make brief warnings less visible.

Counts and percentages describe this retrieved corpus. Article presence measures how widely a future appears, not its textual prominence or the strength of endorsement. An existing designation of the primary account provides a separate descriptive check on prominence. Selected outlet comparisons were also repeated after omitting each outlet in turn; these existing sensitivity checks are reported in Appendix B. Neither procedure changes the main article-level unit.

Close reading examined how the coded relationships were expressed in full source passages. Cases were selected to clarify recurring proposals, contrasting evaluations, and exceptions to the group-level pattern. Quotations reproduce complete sentences and paragraphs from retained source texts in English translation. Attribution identifies the speaker's role or institutional capacity rather than their personal name; quoted journalistic narration is identified as such. Article identifiers link quotations to their publications. Qualitative contrasts describe practices interpreted from these passages, not additional coded groups with separately measured prevalence.

Results

Learning support and AI preparation lead an uneven field of futures

AI as a Learning Partner and AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative dominated the coverage by article prevalence. They appeared in 60.5% and 53.0% of the sample, respectively (Table 4). The first concerns what AI might do for learning; the second concerns what people must learn in response to AI. Educational Judgment formed a substantial third strand, while National Development and Educational Management appeared less frequently. The coverage thus placed educational practice and preparation ahead of institutional administration as explicit objects of future change.

Table 4: Future-role prevalence by outlet group, articles n (%).

Future role	All (828)	Public/central (424)	Commercial/general (404)
AI as a Learning Partner	501 (60.5)	250 (59.0)	251 (62.1)
AI as a Force Reshaping Educational Judgment	312 (37.7)	153 (36.1)	159 (39.4)
AI as an Educational Management Tool	85 (10.3)	55 (13.0)	30 (7.4)
AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative	439 (53.0)	247 (58.3)	192 (47.5)
AI as a Driver of National Development	162 (19.6)	109 (25.7)	53 (13.1)

Note. Each role is counted once per article; roles can coexist. 2 articles in the main sample had no assigned future role and remain in the denominator.

The profiles distinguish these futures by their educational focus (Appendix A). Learning Partner accounts connected AI to learning quality in 61.3% of the 501 articles containing that role and to changes in teaching, learning, or assessment practice in 65.3%. Educators, researchers, and specialists were its most frequent speaking category. A VnExpress contribution by a representative of VioEdu, an FPT educational platform, described a shift in teachers' work:

> In fact, AI will not be able to replace teachers' roles entirely. However, their work in the classroom will change. With AI applied in teaching, teachers take on an observational role and concentrate on communication and emotions—areas in which machines cannot yet replace humans.
>
> — VioEdu/FPT representative, *VnExpress* (VNE19_004)

In the same article, AI-supported administration was expected to free teachers' time for professional work. Learning Partner and Educational Management were therefore complementary: administrative relief was justified through the educational relationships it would enable. Across the 85 articles containing Educational Management, operational feasibility and efficiency was its most frequent rationale (41.2%), while providing resources or implementation capacity was its most frequent action (51.8%). Its smaller presence did not make it a competing alternative to learning; it often concerned the conditions under which educational work could be organised.

AI Literacy moved the object of change from AI-assisted learning to people's capacity to understand and use AI. Its accounts linked changes in practice with curriculum reform and resources, and assigned responsibility to educational organisations in 56.7% of the 439 articles containing the role. National Development extended preparation towards an explicit collective goal. Within its 162 articles, resource provision (55.6%) and curriculum change (50.0%) were the leading actions, while public authorities and educational leadership were the leading speaking categories. The difference was the end being pursued: individual or professional capability in AI Literacy, and collective technological or workforce capacity in National Development.

Educational Judgment focused on what would count as credible achievement when AI could produce assessed work or participate in judging it. Rights, reliability and academic integrity was its leading rationale (58.7% of 312 articles). Changing educational practice and setting rules were both common responses. This role therefore connected technological change to the authority to recognise learning, rather than merely to the efficiency of producing work.

Public/central coverage gives greater weight to institutional preparation

The outlet difference was strongest around preparation and collective development. AI Literacy appeared in 58.3% of public/central articles and 47.5% of commercial/general articles; National Development appeared in 25.7% and 13.1%, respectively. Educational Management was also more frequent in public/central coverage. Learning Partner and Educational Judgment, by contrast, had similar prevalence across the two groups. The comparison points to different emphases within a shared set of futures.

Public/central coverage also more frequently included public authorities, policy-based rationales, and proposals for curriculum and resources (Table 5). Commercial/general coverage included learner voices more often: 17.3%, compared with 7.1%. These distributions locate the group difference in both what futures receive attention and whose accounts enter the discussion.

Table 5: Selected speaking positions, rationales, and actions by outlet group, articles n (%).

Category	Public/central (424)	Commercial/general (404)
Speaker		
Public authority	159 (37.5)	77 (19.1)
Educational institution or leadership	177 (41.7)	121 (30.0)
Educator, researcher or specialist	153 (36.1)	179 (44.3)
Learner	30 (7.1)	70 (17.3)
Rationale		
Policy or standards compliance	83 (19.6)	27 (6.7)
Action recommendation		
Change curriculum content or credentials	186 (43.9)	118 (29.2)
Provide resources or implementation capacity	263 (62.0)	193 (47.8)
Establish coordination or partnerships	125 (29.5)	67 (16.6)
Evaluate the AI intervention	60 (14.2)	21 (5.2)
Action responsibility		
Public authorities	153 (36.1)	80 (19.8)
Educational organisations	253 (59.7)	179 (44.3)

Note. Denominators are all articles in each outlet group. These are separate article-level distributions; the role profiles in Appendix A require linkage within the same account.

The institutional direction was explicit in reporting on the education ministry's draft AI strategy. The report connected widespread AI use to a nationally developed educational ecosystem:

> The strategy sets the overall objective of applying AI comprehensively and systematically across the education sector, towards building a modern, effective, and sustainable

> digital education system. Looking towards 2035, AI will become a common tool for every learner, teacher, and education manager, while an AI ecosystem developed by Vietnamese enterprises will be used consistently in general education.
>
> — Report of the Ministry of Education and Training's draft strategy, *Giáo dục Việt Nam* (GDN25_005)

The article specified curriculum integration, teacher preparation, infrastructure upgrades, institutional rules, and partnerships with technology companies. These proposals gave the envisioned future a timetable and a set of responsible organisations. Its account of safeguards was part of that direction: privacy, responsible use, and testing before wider deployment were presented as requirements for implementation.

Collective development was also advanced through educational and commercial initiatives. In coverage of a school AI and robotics competition, an FPT University admissions director explained its purpose:

> In the context of the Fourth Industrial Revolution, artificial intelligence (AI) and robotics are increasingly establishing their key role in social development. Early exposure to and application of these technologies, especially among school pupils, is an important factor in guiding and developing talent and preparing a high-quality workforce for the country.
>
> — Admissions director, FPT University, *Giáo dục Việt Nam* (GDN25_006)

Here a competition connected pupils' activities to national workforce formation. Together with the draft strategy, the account shows how government and educational providers could advance compatible expectations through different programmes. The National Development role did not belong exclusively to government speakers, just as a public/central outlet did not publish only official voices.

Critical evaluations concentrate on learning and educational judgment

Desirable futures appeared in 96.0% of articles, compared with 33.1% for undesirable futures. The imbalance was substantial, but criticism was concentrated rather than uniformly scarce. Negative evaluations occurred in 37.3% of articles containing Learning Partner and 39.4% of those containing Educational Judgment, compared with much smaller shares for AI Literacy, Educational Management, and National Development (Table 6). The roles receiving the strongest affirmative evaluations were therefore not the same as those carrying the most visible disputes about use.

Table 6: Evaluations linked to each future role, percentage of articles containing that role.

	Whole role sample			Undesirable by outlet group	
Future role	Desirable	Undesirable	Mixed	Public/central	Commercial/general
AI as a Learning Partner	87.4	37.3	12.8	36.4	38.2
AI as a Force Reshaping Educational Judgment	78.2	39.4	5.1	28.8	49.7
AI as an Educational Management Tool	81.2	5.9	3.5	1.8	13.3
AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative	93.2	7.1	1.6	5.3	9.4
AI as a Driver of National Development	94.4	4.3	0.0	6.4	0.0

Note. Whole-role denominators are 501, 312, 85, 439, and 162 articles, respectively. Outlet-specific denominators are the role counts in Table 4. A role and evaluation must occur in the same attributed account. Different evaluations can coexist within an article; "Mixed" requires an explicitly mixed account. Missing and undecided evaluations remain in the denominators and are reported in Appendix A.

In Learning Partner, the tension concerned whether assistance developed or displaced understanding. A Dân trí report described a student's experience of using ChatGPT at a university workshop:

> Drawing on his own experience, the student worried that overusing technology in learning might make students learn quickly but forget quickly, become superficial, and be less willing to think, reflect, or create.
>
> — Journalist's account of a university student's concern, *Dân trí* (DTR24_022)

The report also described benefits and a lecturer's recommendation to use ChatGPT as a supporting tool. Faster task completion and stronger learning were treated as different outcomes, making dependence a problem within the imagined learning relationship. Negative evaluations in this role were similarly frequent across the outlet groups: 36.4% in public/central and 38.2% in commercial/general articles containing it.

Educational Judgment showed a sharper outlet difference. Although the role's overall prevalence was similar, negative evaluations appeared in 49.7% of commercial/general articles containing it, compared with 28.8% of public/central articles. Disagreement also concerned how credible assessment should be protected. A government-news report described technical detection and police–education coordination to prevent AI-enabled examination cheating (BCP26_009). A Tia Sáng commentary instead argued for assessment grounded in interaction with learners:

> Alternatives do exist. From mini oral defences to reflective portfolios, from supervised group assignments to staged reflective writing, all help restore human relationships in

> education and reduce dependence on machines. These are forms of assessment that do not exclude AI, but neither do they elevate it into a tool of moral surveillance.
>
> — Independent education researcher, authorial commentary, *Tia Sáng* (TSG25_001)

Both articles belonged to the public/central group. Their shared concern with credible achievement supported different practices: detection and enforcement in one account, dialogue and evidence of the learning process in the other. The latter offered a positively valued alternative while criticising detector-based judgments. Negative desirability therefore captures one part of critical discussion, rather than every proposal that questions an existing AI application.

Nor was National Development wholly affirmative. Its seven articles with linked negative evaluations all appeared in public/central outlets. In a VOV account, a university AI-capacity programme director warned that dependence could produce people able to operate technology without developing thought, weakening national capabilities (VOV25_009). The same account promoted critical AI competence. National capability supplied a reason both to prepare people for AI and to challenge uses that might undermine that preparation.

Across the full sample, commercial/general articles contained negative evaluations more frequently (37.9% versus 28.5%). Explicitly mixed accounts differed little between the groups (9.2% and 8.5%). The existing primary-account designation provided a separate indication of emphasis: desirable evaluations occupied the primary position in 83.0% of articles, compared with 9.7% for undesirable evaluations. Warnings were more widely included than selected as the principal evaluated future, while close reading showed that some critical interventions took the form of positively valued alternatives.

Discussion

Vietnamese news gave unequal visibility to a shared set of educational AI futures. The strongest contrast lay between the broad presence of learning support, the institutional emphasis on preparation, and the concentration of negative evaluations around learning and assessment. Public/central coverage gave greater weight to AI Literacy and National Development; commercial/general coverage more often included negative assessments of Educational Judgment. This pattern explains how an affirmative direction can be sustained without eliminating disagreement over what AI should do in education.

The findings connect plurality to selection through public attention and institutional justification. National Development was not the most prevalent future overall, but it was substantially more frequent in public/central coverage and was articulated through public authorities, educational leadership, resources, and curricula. The draft-strategy account made this connection concrete by

specifying a horizon for widespread AI use and the organisations expected to realise it. Taken together, these observations support an interpretation of preferential visibility for institutionally actionable futures: proposals gain a clearer route to implementation when they are connected to recognised authorities and concrete programmes. This is the communicative dimension of selection identified by the study. Bareis & Katzenbach (2022) locate the performative force of national AI imaginaries in policy commitments and resources; the present analysis shows how related directions are presented and justified in news.

Following the approach developed by Brause et al. (2024) and Brause et al. (2025), the analysis also shows why future roles need to be read through their other dimensions. Learning support, institutional efficiency, and national development are familiar expectations. Their significance becomes clearer when tied to particular relations and obligations. In one account, administrative relief enables teachers to concentrate on pupils. In another, technological change requires educational organisations to revise curricula and develop AI competence. Such connections give content to broad promises of improvement. They also make educational preparation appear necessary: once an AI-oriented future is treated as the setting in which people will live and work, education is called upon to equip them for it. This finding develops Rahm's (2023) account of education as a means of governing anticipated technological change.

The outlet comparison shows that institutional and commercial agendas can reinforce one another. National workforce formation was promoted through a commercial university's competition as well as through government planning, while learning assistance was described by a technology-provider representative. These cases complement Nguyen et al.'s (2026) finding that developmental aspirations and industry participation coexist in Vietnamese AI reporting. The contribution here is to locate those connections within specific educational futures. The commercial/general group's greater inclusion of negative evaluations does not amount to a uniformly oppositional position: its learning-support coverage was as extensive as public/central coverage, and the difference in negative assessment was much sharper for Educational Judgment than for Learning Partner.

Critical accounts qualified the direction of change in more than one way. The student's concern separated efficient completion from retained understanding; the assessment commentary distinguished trustworthy judgment from reliance on detection. These are disagreements about what counts as educational improvement. They fit Rahm and Rahm-Skågeby's (2023) argument that proposed technologies carry problem definitions, and Linderoth et al.'s (2024) finding that different visions of education can guide different responses to AI. Some responses restrict a practice, some redesign it, and others strengthen the capabilities needed to use AI. They need not form mutually exclusive futures.

The imbalance in desirability gives these disagreements their setting. Affirmative evaluations were

far more widespread and more frequently primary, while negative evaluations clustered around learning and assessment. Yet the Tia Sáng account demonstrates why counting negative statements alone would understate the scope of criticism: a desired future based on dialogue can challenge technological control. The analytical distinction is therefore between evaluating an arrangement negatively and proposing a different arrangement, not between a positive mainstream and a single negative alternative. News makes both visible, although with unequal frequency and emphasis. For comparative education, this locates the contribution of media analysis between policy and practice: it reveals which educational expectations circulate with institutional justification and where the meaning of improvement remains open to dispute.

Limitations

The corpus is bounded by Google News indexing and retrieval limits, selected domains and search vocabulary, title screening, and recoverable texts. Assessment and academic-integrity terms were explicitly included in queries and may have increased the visibility of Educational Judgment. Search vocabulary changed across periods, early years were sparse, and 2026 was incomplete. The analysis therefore describes the retrieved corpus rather than the distribution of all Vietnamese news. The approximate outlet groups capture publishing orientation and institutional affiliation, not a state–private ownership divide. Differences may also reflect outlet, year, event, and source composition.

AI-assisted extraction and coding are interpretive. Source-linked evidence and automated validation improve traceability but do not establish semantic validity or independent agreement. The five-role revision retained the other eleven fields and account boundaries, so errors in those earlier decisions could carry into the revised profiles. The researcher's exploratory coding informed category development; it is not reported as a random reliability sample. Role breadth also affects prevalence: a broad learning relationship can encompass more proposals than a narrowly defined administrative function. Missing fields and unassigned roles remain in their stated denominators.

Article presence gives a brief mention and an extended discussion equal weight. Within-role profiles preserve linkage inside accounts but do not measure the strength of associations or imply that all listed features occur in a single proposition. Primary position is an existing coder judgment about the prominent arrangement, not a direct measure of headline placement, textual length, or editorial intention. Close readings illustrate differences in practice; those practices have not been separately coded as mutually exclusive categories. Desirability is target-specific and cannot serve as an exhaustive measure of criticism.

Repeated quotations and event material remain in the corpus as instances of circulation, so article counts do not represent independent endorsements. News evidence establishes neither audience acceptance nor implementation. The interpretation of selection concerns published visibility and

justification; it cannot reconstruct editorial decisions, demonstrate government direction of particular stories, or establish which proposals received funding. Following these futures into institutional decisions and educational practice would require additional evidence.

Conclusion

Five familiar futures organised Vietnamese educational AI coverage, but they received unequal attention. Learning Partner and AI Literacy were the most prevalent; Educational Judgment carried substantial debate, while Educational Management and National Development occupied smaller shares. Their profiles showed how educational goals were connected to different speakers, reasons, and responsibilities. Public/central outlets gave greater weight to preparation and collective development, while commercial/general outlets more frequently included negative evaluations of educational judgment. The groups shared much of the same repertoire, with differences in what they emphasised and how it was evaluated.

The central finding is that plurality coexists with an affirmative direction of change. Institutional programmes make AI-related preparation and development publicly actionable, while critical accounts question whether particular uses support learning and credible judgment. Some of those accounts advocate positively valued alternatives, so their contribution cannot be reduced to negative sentiment. News analysis reveals which futures receive wider visibility and institutional justification, and which educational questions remain contested within that direction.

References

Bareis, J., & Katzenbach, C. (2022). Talking AI into being: The narratives and imaginaries of national AI strategies and their performative politics. *Science, Technology, & Human Values*, *47*(5), 855–881. https://doi.org/10.1177/01622439211030007

Brause, S. R., Schäfer, M. S., Katzenbach, C., Mao, Y., Richter, V., & Zeng, J. (2025). Sociotechnical imaginaries and public communication: Analytical framework and empirical illustration using the case of artificial intelligence. *Convergence: The International Journal of Research into New Media Technologies*, *31*(4), 1267–1287. https://doi.org/10.1177/13548565251338192

Brause, S. R., Yang, H., Schäfer, M. S., & Zeng, J. (2024). News media imaginaries of artificial intelligence in healthcare: A qualitative analysis across China, Germany, and the United States. *Emerging Media*, *2*(4), 581–610. https://doi.org/10.1177/27523543241300185

Bulathwela, S., Pérez-Ortiz, M., Holloway, C., & Shawe-Taylor, J. (2021). *Could AI democratise education? Socio-technical imaginaries of an EdTech revolution*. arXiv. https://arxiv.org/abs/2112.02034

Cave, S., & Dihal, K. (2019). Hopes and fears for intelligent machines in fiction and reality. *Nature Machine Intelligence*, *1*(2), 74–78. https://doi.org/10.1038/s42256-019-0020-9

Hendriks, A., Karhunmaa, K., & Delvenne, P. (2025). Shaping the future: A conceptual review of sociotechnical imaginaries. *Futures*, *170*, Article 103607. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.futures.2025.103607

Hrastinski, S., Olofsson, A. D., Arkenback, C., Ekström, S., Ericsson, E., Fransson, G., Jaldemark, J., Ryberg, T., Öberg, L.-M., Fuentes, A., Gustafsson, U., Humble, N., Mozelius, P., Sundgren, M., & Utterberg, M. (2019). Critical imaginaries and reflections on artificial intelligence and robots in postdigital K-12 education. *Postdigital Science and Education*, *1*(2), 427–445. https://doi.org/10.1007/s42438-019-00046-x

Huang, X., & Gadavanij, S. (2025). Power and marginalization in discourse on AI in education (AIEd): Social actors' representation in China Daily (2018–2023). *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, *12*(1), Article 412. https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-025-04621-5

Jasanoff, S., & Kim, S.-H. (2009). Containing the atom: Sociotechnical imaginaries and nuclear power in the United States and South Korea. *Minerva*, *47*(2), 119–146. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11024-009-9124-4

Jasanoff, S., & Kim, S.-H. (Eds.). (2015). *Dreamscapes of modernity: Sociotechnical imaginaries and the fabrication of power*. University of Chicago Press. https://press.uchicago.edu/ucp/books/book/chicago/D/bo20836025.html

Linderoth, C., Hultén, M., & Stenliden, L. (2024). Competing visions of artificial intelligence in education—a heuristic analysis on sociotechnical imaginaries and problematizations in policy guidelines. *Policy Futures in Education*, *22*(8), 1662–1678. https://doi.org/10.1177/14782103241228900

Luong, D. N. A. (2022). *How the party-state retains controls over Vietnam's blossoming media landscape* (ISEAS Perspective 2022/79). ISEAS–Yusof Ishak Institute. https://www.iseas.edu.sg/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/ISEAS_Perspective_2022_79.pdf

Mamlok, D. (2025). Landscapes of sociotechnical imaginaries in education: A theoretical examination of integrating artificial intelligence in education. *Foundations of Science*, *30*(2), 529–540. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10699-024-09948-x

Nemorin, S., Vlachidis, A., Ayerakwa, H. M., & Andriotis, P. (2023). AI hyped? A horizon scan of discourse on artificial intelligence in education (AIED) and development. *Learning, Media and Technology*, *48*(1), 38–51. https://doi.org/10.1080/17439884.2022.2095568

Nguyen, H.-K. T., Hoang, T.-D., Le, D.-A. Q., Tran, T.-N. T., & Ho, M.-T. (2026). Pre-generative AI perspectives: Risk and promise in Vietnam's state media narratives on artificial intelligence (2016–2022). *Society*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12115-026-01198-w

Nguyen-Thu, G. (2019). *Television in post-reform Vietnam: Nation, media, market*. Routledge.

https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315157382

Prime Minister of Vietnam. (2021). *Decision no. 127/QĐ-TTg: National strategy on research, development and application of artificial intelligence until 2030*. https://congbao.chinhphu.vn/van-ban/quyet-dinh-so-127-qd-ttg-33096/34502.htm

Prime Minister of Vietnam. (2022). *Decision no. 131/QĐ-TTg: Strengthening information technology application and digital transformation in education and training for 2022–2025, with orientation to 2030*. https://chinhphu.vn/?classid=0&docid=205236&pageid=27160

Rahm, L. (2023). Educational imaginaries: Governance at the intersection of technology and education. *Journal of Education Policy*, *38*(1), 46–68. https://doi.org/10.1080/02680939.2021.1970233

Rahm, L., & Rahm-Skågeby, J. (2023). Imaginaries and problematisations: A heuristic lens in the age of artificial intelligence in education. *British Journal of Educational Technology*, *54*(5), 1147–1159. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjet.13319

Richter, V., Katzenbach, C., & Zeng, J. (2025). Negotiating AI(s) futures: Competing imaginaries of AI by stakeholders in the U.S., China, and Germany. *Journal of Science Communication*, *24*(02), Article A08. https://doi.org/10.22323/2.24020208

Wang, W., Downey, J., & Yang, F. (2025). AI anxiety? Comparing the sociotechnical imaginaries of artificial intelligence in UK, Chinese and Indian newspapers. *Global Media and China*, *10*(4), 425–441. https://doi.org/10.1177/20594364231196547

Wieczorek, M., & Romele, A. (2026). How to imagine educational AI: The filling of a pail or the lighting of a fire? *Educational Theory*, *76*(3), 316–338. https://doi.org/10.1111/edth.70070

Appendix A. Complete profiles within the five future roles

Tables below report articles n (%) for all eleven remaining fields, linked to a role within an attributed account. Each article counts once per role–code pair. Denominators are articles containing the role, including those missing the field. "No assigned substantive code" means no account bearing that role supplied a substantive code for the field. A row total is not a partition of the sample: roles and codes can overlap.

Column abbreviations refer to the unchanged codebook labels: LP, AI as a Learning Partner; EJ, AI as a Force Reshaping Educational Judgment; EM, AI as an Educational Management Tool; AL, AI Literacy as an Educational Imperative; ND, AI as a Driver of National Development. The same key applies to all three tables.

Table 7: Complete role profiles, all articles containing each role, n (%).

Category	LP (n=501)	EJ (n=312)	EM (n=85)	AL (n=439)	ND (n=162)
Certainty					
Confident prediction	185 (36.9)	89 (28.5)	22 (25.9)	103 (23.5)	28 (17.3)
Possible outcome	257 (51.3)	103 (33.0)	33 (38.8)	77 (17.5)	20 (12.3)
Denied outcome or capability	68 (13.6)	22 (7.1)	3 (3.5)	13 (3.0)	0 (0.0)
Explicitly unresolved outcome	6 (1.2)	4 (1.3)	0 (0.0)	3 (0.7)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	131 (26.1)	128 (41.0)	33 (38.8)	269 (61.3)	121 (74.7)
Desirability					
Desirable	438 (87.4)	244 (78.2)	69 (81.2)	409 (93.2)	153 (94.4)
Undesirable	187 (37.3)	123 (39.4)	5 (5.9)	31 (7.1)	7 (4.3)
Explicitly mixed	64 (12.8)	16 (5.1)	3 (3.5)	7 (1.6)	0 (0.0)
Value explicitly undecided	0 (0.0)	1 (0.3)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	14 (2.8)	23 (7.4)	13 (15.3)	23 (5.2)	6 (3.7)
Rationale					
Learning quality	307 (61.3)	84 (26.9)	9 (10.6)	195 (44.4)	22 (13.6)
Operational feasibility and efficiency	126 (25.1)	46 (14.7)	35 (41.2)	88 (20.0)	23 (14.2)
Employment and economic returns	33 (6.6)	15 (4.8)	4 (4.7)	113 (25.7)	51 (31.5)
Equality of opportunity	38 (7.6)	6 (1.9)	4 (4.7)	36 (8.2)	5 (3.1)
Rights, reliability and academic integrity	104 (20.8)	183 (58.7)	15 (17.6)	70 (15.9)	3 (1.9)
Human, civic and cultural values	83 (16.6)	16 (5.1)	5 (5.9)	56 (12.8)	12 (7.4)
National development and strategic autonomy	7 (1.4)	1 (0.3)	3 (3.5)	21 (4.8)	81 (50.0)
Policy or standards compliance	27 (5.4)	16 (5.1)	1 (1.2)	64 (14.6)	24 (14.8)
No assigned substantive code	78 (15.6)	54 (17.3)	31 (36.5)	87 (19.8)	25 (15.4)
Technology characteristics					
Generative AI	302 (60.3)	198 (63.5)	17 (20.0)	135 (30.8)	22 (13.6)
Predictive or discriminative AI	91 (18.2)	66 (21.2)	32 (37.6)	37 (8.4)	10 (6.2)
AI form unspecified	272 (54.3)	119 (38.1)	43 (50.6)	330 (75.2)	139 (85.8)
No assigned substantive code	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
Technology context					
School education	278 (55.5)	139 (44.6)	47 (55.3)	206 (46.9)	67 (41.4)
Higher education	208 (41.5)	149 (47.8)	25 (29.4)	196 (44.6)	89 (54.9)
Vocational education	12 (2.4)	5 (1.6)	3 (3.5)	14 (3.2)	8 (4.9)
Professional and workplace development	29 (5.8)	13 (4.2)	1 (1.2)	108 (24.6)	28 (17.3)
Community and informal education	14 (2.8)	2 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	9 (2.1)	5 (3.1)
No assigned substantive code	52 (10.4)	40 (12.8)	13 (15.3)	28 (6.4)	12 (7.4)
Timespan					
Immediate / being realised	170 (33.9)	91 (29.2)	25 (29.4)	131 (29.8)	28 (17.3)
Near-term	39 (7.8)	36 (11.5)	6 (7.1)	36 (8.2)	14 (8.6)

(continued)

Category	LP (n=501)	EJ (n=312)	EM (n=85)	AL (n=439)	ND (n=162)
Distant / long-term	24 (4.8)	12 (3.8)	0 (0.0)	19 (4.3)	18 (11.1)
Ongoing / continuous	34 (6.8)	12 (3.8)	1 (1.2)	79 (18.0)	16 (9.9)
Explicit horizon; proximity unstated	68 (13.6)	50 (16.0)	14 (16.5)	142 (32.3)	47 (29.0)
No assigned substantive code	236 (47.1)	148 (47.4)	47 (55.3)	142 (32.3)	67 (41.4)
Space					
Vietnam	109 (21.8)	59 (18.9)	26 (30.6)	158 (36.0)	106 (65.4)
Specific foreign country	80 (16.0)	88 (28.2)	9 (10.6)	43 (9.8)	19 (11.7)
Cross-national or global	41 (8.2)	17 (5.4)	2 (2.4)	33 (7.5)	17 (10.5)
No assigned substantive code	288 (57.5)	158 (50.6)	48 (56.5)	222 (50.6)	31 (19.1)
Speaker					
Public authority	75 (15.0)	74 (23.7)	20 (23.5)	111 (25.3)	51 (31.5)
Educational institution or leadership	123 (24.6)	70 (22.4)	27 (31.8)	166 (37.8)	49 (30.2)
Educator, researcher or specialist	227 (45.3)	133 (42.6)	13 (15.3)	123 (28.0)	20 (12.3)
Commercial actor	81 (16.2)	32 (10.3)	14 (16.5)	42 (9.6)	27 (16.7)
Learner	59 (11.8)	29 (9.3)	4 (4.7)	25 (5.7)	1 (0.6)
Family or caregiver	16 (3.2)	4 (1.3)	1 (1.2)	5 (1.1)	0 (0.0)
Civic or international organisation	19 (3.8)	6 (1.9)	6 (7.1)	22 (5.0)	9 (5.6)
Article's authorial voice	190 (37.9)	92 (29.5)	23 (27.1)	123 (28.0)	42 (25.9)
No assigned substantive code	3 (0.6)	7 (2.2)	1 (1.2)	4 (0.9)	2 (1.2)
Affected entities					
Learners	476 (95.0)	293 (93.9)	64 (75.3)	402 (91.6)	128 (79.0)
Education and research workers	266 (53.1)	153 (49.0)	55 (64.7)	175 (39.9)	32 (19.8)
Educational organisations	89 (17.8)	62 (19.9)	47 (55.3)	74 (16.9)	34 (21.0)
Families and caregivers	22 (4.4)	5 (1.6)	17 (20.0)	17 (3.9)	0 (0.0)
Employers and non-education occupational actors	13 (2.6)	8 (2.6)	4 (4.7)	36 (8.2)	25 (15.4)
Wider communities or society	28 (5.6)	8 (2.6)	5 (5.9)	40 (9.1)	97 (59.9)
No assigned substantive code	2 (0.4)	2 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	6 (1.4)	1 (0.6)
Action recommendation					
Change curriculum content or credentials	57 (11.4)	37 (11.9)	4 (4.7)	234 (53.3)	81 (50.0)
Change learning, teaching or assessment practice	327 (65.3)	187 (59.9)	32 (37.6)	271 (61.7)	45 (27.8)
Provide resources or implementation capacity	175 (34.9)	89 (28.5)	44 (51.8)	229 (52.2)	90 (55.6)
Set rules, safeguards or restrictions	109 (21.8)	157 (50.3)	19 (22.4)	79 (18.0)	21 (13.0)
Establish coordination or partnerships	46 (9.2)	22 (7.1)	15 (17.6)	105 (23.9)	55 (34.0)
Evaluate the AI intervention	36 (7.2)	10 (3.2)	12 (14.1)	33 (7.5)	6 (3.7)
No assigned substantive code	77 (15.4)	41 (13.1)	12 (14.1)	18 (4.1)	15 (9.3)
Action responsibility					
Public authorities	68 (13.6)	76 (24.4)	16 (18.8)	101 (23.0)	47 (29.0)
Educational organisations	130 (25.9)	118 (37.8)	36 (42.4)	249 (56.7)	81 (50.0)
Education and research workers	188 (37.5)	111 (35.6)	12 (14.1)	114 (26.0)	15 (9.3)
Learners	160 (31.9)	72 (23.1)	9 (10.6)	108 (24.6)	13 (8.0)
Families and caregivers	21 (4.2)	4 (1.3)	3 (3.5)	10 (2.3)	2 (1.2)
Commercial actors	72 (14.4)	25 (8.0)	17 (20.0)	59 (13.4)	45 (27.8)
Civic or international collectives	10 (2.0)	1 (0.3)	2 (2.4)	16 (3.6)	6 (3.7)
No assigned substantive code	116 (23.2)	78 (25.0)	26 (30.6)	63 (14.4)	35 (21.6)

Table 8: Complete role profiles within public/central outlets, n (%).

Category	LP (n=250)	EJ (n=153)	EM (n=55)	AL (n=247)	ND (n=109)
Certainty					
Confident prediction	90 (36.0)	40 (26.1)	14 (25.5)	53 (21.5)	18 (16.5)
Possible outcome	122 (48.8)	43 (28.1)	20 (36.4)	37 (15.0)	16 (14.7)
Denied outcome or capability	29 (11.6)	6 (3.9)	1 (1.8)	2 (0.8)	0 (0.0)

(continued)

Category	LP (n=250)	EJ (n=153)	EM (n=55)	AL (n=247)	ND (n=109)
Explicitly unresolved outcome	2 (0.8)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	76 (30.4)	78 (51.0)	23 (41.8)	164 (66.4)	79 (72.5)
Desirability					
Desirable	221 (88.4)	123 (80.4)	49 (89.1)	230 (93.1)	104 (95.4)
Undesirable	91 (36.4)	44 (28.8)	1 (1.8)	13 (5.3)	7 (6.4)
Explicitly mixed	32 (12.8)	8 (5.2)	1 (1.8)	5 (2.0)	0 (0.0)
Value explicitly undecided	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	7 (2.8)	13 (8.5)	6 (10.9)	14 (5.7)	2 (1.8)
Rationale					
Learning quality	148 (59.2)	47 (30.7)	6 (10.9)	108 (43.7)	19 (17.4)
Operational feasibility and efficiency	66 (26.4)	20 (13.1)	23 (41.8)	67 (27.1)	17 (15.6)
Employment and economic returns	16 (6.4)	8 (5.2)	2 (3.6)	58 (23.5)	36 (33.0)
Equality of opportunity	22 (8.8)	5 (3.3)	3 (5.5)	28 (11.3)	4 (3.7)
Rights, reliability and academic integrity	49 (19.6)	85 (55.6)	9 (16.4)	50 (20.2)	2 (1.8)
Human, civic and cultural values	48 (19.2)	11 (7.2)	3 (5.5)	39 (15.8)	10 (9.2)
National development and strategic autonomy	7 (2.8)	0 (0.0)	3 (5.5)	16 (6.5)	57 (52.3)
Policy or standards compliance	20 (8.0)	10 (6.5)	1 (1.8)	51 (20.6)	17 (15.6)
No assigned substantive code	38 (15.2)	29 (19.0)	19 (34.5)	43 (17.4)	17 (15.6)
Technology characteristics					
Generative AI	145 (58.0)	89 (58.2)	9 (16.4)	69 (27.9)	20 (18.3)
Predictive or discriminative AI	55 (22.0)	29 (19.0)	17 (30.9)	19 (7.7)	6 (5.5)
AI form unspecified	145 (58.0)	67 (43.8)	35 (63.6)	193 (78.1)	90 (82.6)
No assigned substantive code	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
Technology context					
School education	143 (57.2)	72 (47.1)	30 (54.5)	121 (49.0)	38 (34.9)
Higher education	100 (40.0)	65 (42.5)	15 (27.3)	108 (43.7)	61 (56.0)
Vocational education	9 (3.6)	4 (2.6)	3 (5.5)	12 (4.9)	7 (6.4)
Professional and workplace development	23 (9.2)	10 (6.5)	1 (1.8)	74 (30.0)	26 (23.9)
Community and informal education	5 (2.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	2 (0.8)	4 (3.7)
No assigned substantive code	23 (9.2)	22 (14.4)	9 (16.4)	12 (4.9)	8 (7.3)
Timespan					
Immediate / being realised	87 (34.8)	42 (27.5)	16 (29.1)	90 (36.4)	18 (16.5)
Near-term	20 (8.0)	15 (9.8)	3 (5.5)	24 (9.7)	6 (5.5)
Distant / long-term	14 (5.6)	7 (4.6)	0 (0.0)	15 (6.1)	12 (11.0)
Ongoing / continuous	14 (5.6)	5 (3.3)	0 (0.0)	45 (18.2)	14 (12.8)
Explicit horizon; proximity unstated	41 (16.4)	28 (18.3)	11 (20.0)	75 (30.4)	26 (23.9)
No assigned substantive code	113 (45.2)	73 (47.7)	29 (52.7)	71 (28.7)	51 (46.8)
Space					
Vietnam	71 (28.4)	37 (24.2)	16 (29.1)	101 (40.9)	74 (67.9)
Specific foreign country	30 (12.0)	31 (20.3)	4 (7.3)	20 (8.1)	11 (10.1)
Cross-national or global	22 (8.8)	10 (6.5)	1 (1.8)	12 (4.9)	11 (10.1)
No assigned substantive code	136 (54.4)	80 (52.3)	34 (61.8)	124 (50.2)	22 (20.2)
Speaker					
Public authority	54 (21.6)	44 (28.8)	18 (32.7)	84 (34.0)	34 (31.2)
Educational institution or leadership	79 (31.6)	38 (24.8)	16 (29.1)	99 (40.1)	36 (33.0)
Educator, researcher or specialist	104 (41.6)	56 (36.6)	7 (12.7)	65 (26.3)	16 (14.7)
Commercial actor	38 (15.2)	12 (7.8)	10 (18.2)	17 (6.9)	19 (17.4)
Learner	17 (6.8)	8 (5.2)	1 (1.8)	10 (4.0)	0 (0.0)
Family or caregiver	9 (3.6)	1 (0.7)	0 (0.0)	1 (0.4)	0 (0.0)
Civic or international organisation	10 (4.0)	3 (2.0)	3 (5.5)	12 (4.9)	8 (7.3)
Article's authorial voice	81 (32.4)	39 (25.5)	13 (23.6)	63 (25.5)	31 (28.4)
No assigned substantive code	2 (0.8)	2 (1.3)	1 (1.8)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
Affected entities					
Learners	236 (94.4)	144 (94.1)	43 (78.2)	221 (89.5)	86 (78.9)
Education and research workers	154 (61.6)	75 (49.0)	37 (67.3)	117 (47.4)	27 (24.8)
Educational organisations	63 (25.2)	37 (24.2)	32 (58.2)	51 (20.6)	27 (24.8)
Families and caregivers	12 (4.8)	2 (1.3)	12 (21.8)	10 (4.0)	0 (0.0)

(continued)

Category	LP (n=250)	EJ (n=153)	EM (n=55)	AL (n=247)	ND (n=109)
Employers and non-education occupational actors	7 (2.8)	3 (2.0)	4 (7.3)	22 (8.9)	15 (13.8)
Wider communities or society	25 (10.0)	3 (2.0)	5 (9.1)	29 (11.7)	69 (63.3)
No assigned substantive code	1 (0.4)	1 (0.7)	0 (0.0)	6 (2.4)	1 (0.9)
Action recommendation					
Change curriculum content or credentials	39 (15.6)	30 (19.6)	3 (5.5)	137 (55.5)	56 (51.4)
Change learning, teaching or assessment practice	167 (66.8)	96 (62.7)	19 (34.5)	155 (62.8)	36 (33.0)
Provide resources or implementation capacity	103 (41.2)	47 (30.7)	27 (49.1)	139 (56.3)	60 (55.0)
Set rules, safeguards or restrictions	68 (27.2)	77 (50.3)	15 (27.3)	54 (21.9)	16 (14.7)
Establish coordination or partnerships	30 (12.0)	11 (7.2)	12 (21.8)	67 (27.1)	42 (38.5)
Evaluate the AI intervention	27 (10.8)	5 (3.3)	9 (16.4)	23 (9.3)	6 (5.5)
No assigned substantive code	25 (10.0)	12 (7.8)	8 (14.5)	7 (2.8)	10 (9.2)
Action responsibility					
Public authorities	48 (19.2)	42 (27.5)	14 (25.5)	76 (30.8)	28 (25.7)
Educational organisations	83 (33.2)	61 (39.9)	22 (40.0)	156 (63.2)	54 (49.5)
Education and research workers	102 (40.8)	45 (29.4)	6 (10.9)	70 (28.3)	12 (11.0)
Learners	65 (26.0)	35 (22.9)	4 (7.3)	59 (23.9)	7 (6.4)
Families and caregivers	9 (3.6)	1 (0.7)	2 (3.6)	5 (2.0)	0 (0.0)
Commercial actors	40 (16.0)	11 (7.2)	12 (21.8)	33 (13.4)	29 (26.6)
Civic or international collectives	5 (2.0)	1 (0.7)	1 (1.8)	10 (4.0)	5 (4.6)
No assigned substantive code	47 (18.8)	36 (23.5)	19 (34.5)	32 (13.0)	29 (26.6)

Table 9: Complete role profiles within commercial/general outlets, n (%).

Category	LP (n=251)	EJ (n=159)	EM (n=30)	AL (n=192)	ND (n=53)
Certainty					
Confident prediction	95 (37.8)	49 (30.8)	8 (26.7)	50 (26.0)	10 (18.9)
Possible outcome	135 (53.8)	60 (37.7)	13 (43.3)	40 (20.8)	4 (7.5)
Denied outcome or capability	39 (15.5)	16 (10.1)	2 (6.7)	11 (5.7)	0 (0.0)
Explicitly unresolved outcome	4 (1.6)	4 (2.5)	0 (0.0)	3 (1.6)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	55 (21.9)	50 (31.4)	10 (33.3)	105 (54.7)	42 (79.2)
Desirability					
Desirable	217 (86.5)	121 (76.1)	20 (66.7)	179 (93.2)	49 (92.5)
Undesirable	96 (38.2)	79 (49.7)	4 (13.3)	18 (9.4)	0 (0.0)
Explicitly mixed	32 (12.7)	8 (5.0)	2 (6.7)	2 (1.0)	0 (0.0)
Value explicitly undecided	0 (0.0)	1 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	7 (2.8)	10 (6.3)	7 (23.3)	9 (4.7)	4 (7.5)
Rationale					
Learning quality	159 (63.3)	37 (23.3)	3 (10.0)	87 (45.3)	3 (5.7)
Operational feasibility and efficiency	60 (23.9)	26 (16.4)	12 (40.0)	21 (10.9)	6 (11.3)
Employment and economic returns	17 (6.8)	7 (4.4)	2 (6.7)	55 (28.6)	15 (28.3)
Equality of opportunity	16 (6.4)	1 (0.6)	1 (3.3)	8 (4.2)	1 (1.9)
Rights, reliability and academic integrity	55 (21.9)	98 (61.6)	6 (20.0)	20 (10.4)	1 (1.9)
Human, civic and cultural values	35 (13.9)	5 (3.1)	2 (6.7)	17 (8.9)	2 (3.8)
National development and strategic autonomy	0 (0.0)	1 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	5 (2.6)	24 (45.3)
Policy or standards compliance	7 (2.8)	6 (3.8)	0 (0.0)	13 (6.8)	7 (13.2)
No assigned substantive code	40 (15.9)	25 (15.7)	12 (40.0)	44 (22.9)	8 (15.1)
Technology characteristics					
Generative AI	157 (62.5)	109 (68.6)	8 (26.7)	66 (34.4)	2 (3.8)
Predictive or discriminative AI	36 (14.3)	37 (23.3)	15 (50.0)	18 (9.4)	4 (7.5)
AI form unspecified	127 (50.6)	52 (32.7)	8 (26.7)	137 (71.4)	49 (92.5)
No assigned substantive code	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)

(continued)

Category	LP (n=251)	EJ (n=159)	EM (n=30)	AL (n=192)	ND (n=53)
Technology context					
School education	135 (53.8)	67 (42.1)	17 (56.7)	85 (44.3)	29 (54.7)
Higher education	108 (43.0)	84 (52.8)	10 (33.3)	88 (45.8)	28 (52.8)
Vocational education	3 (1.2)	1 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	2 (1.0)	1 (1.9)
Professional and workplace development	6 (2.4)	3 (1.9)	0 (0.0)	34 (17.7)	2 (3.8)
Community and informal education	9 (3.6)	2 (1.3)	0 (0.0)	7 (3.6)	1 (1.9)
No assigned substantive code	29 (11.6)	18 (11.3)	4 (13.3)	16 (8.3)	4 (7.5)
Timespan					
Immediate / being realised	83 (33.1)	49 (30.8)	9 (30.0)	41 (21.4)	10 (18.9)
Near-term	19 (7.6)	21 (13.2)	3 (10.0)	12 (6.2)	8 (15.1)
Distant / long-term	10 (4.0)	5 (3.1)	0 (0.0)	4 (2.1)	6 (11.3)
Ongoing / continuous	20 (8.0)	7 (4.4)	1 (3.3)	34 (17.7)	2 (3.8)
Explicit horizon; proximity unstated	27 (10.8)	22 (13.8)	3 (10.0)	67 (34.9)	21 (39.6)
No assigned substantive code	123 (49.0)	75 (47.2)	18 (60.0)	71 (37.0)	16 (30.2)
Space					
Vietnam	38 (15.1)	22 (13.8)	10 (33.3)	57 (29.7)	32 (60.4)
Specific foreign country	50 (19.9)	57 (35.8)	5 (16.7)	23 (12.0)	8 (15.1)
Cross-national or global	19 (7.6)	7 (4.4)	1 (3.3)	21 (10.9)	6 (11.3)
No assigned substantive code	152 (60.6)	78 (49.1)	14 (46.7)	98 (51.0)	9 (17.0)
Speaker					
Public authority	21 (8.4)	30 (18.9)	2 (6.7)	27 (14.1)	17 (32.1)
Educational institution or leadership	44 (17.5)	32 (20.1)	11 (36.7)	67 (34.9)	13 (24.5)
Educator, researcher or specialist	123 (49.0)	77 (48.4)	6 (20.0)	58 (30.2)	4 (7.5)
Commercial actor	43 (17.1)	20 (12.6)	4 (13.3)	25 (13.0)	8 (15.1)
Learner	42 (16.7)	21 (13.2)	3 (10.0)	15 (7.8)	1 (1.9)
Family or caregiver	7 (2.8)	3 (1.9)	1 (3.3)	4 (2.1)	0 (0.0)
Civic or international organisation	9 (3.6)	3 (1.9)	3 (10.0)	10 (5.2)	1 (1.9)
Article's authorial voice	109 (43.4)	53 (33.3)	10 (33.3)	60 (31.2)	11 (20.8)
No assigned substantive code	1 (0.4)	5 (3.1)	0 (0.0)	4 (2.1)	2 (3.8)
Affected entities					
Learners	240 (95.6)	149 (93.7)	21 (70.0)	181 (94.3)	42 (79.2)
Education and research workers	112 (44.6)	78 (49.1)	18 (60.0)	58 (30.2)	5 (9.4)
Educational organisations	26 (10.4)	25 (15.7)	15 (50.0)	23 (12.0)	7 (13.2)
Families and caregivers	10 (4.0)	3 (1.9)	5 (16.7)	7 (3.6)	0 (0.0)
Employers and non-education occupational actors	6 (2.4)	5 (3.1)	0 (0.0)	14 (7.3)	10 (18.9)
Wider communities or society	3 (1.2)	5 (3.1)	0 (0.0)	11 (5.7)	28 (52.8)
No assigned substantive code	1 (0.4)	1 (0.6)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)
Action recommendation					
Change curriculum content or credentials	18 (7.2)	7 (4.4)	1 (3.3)	97 (50.5)	25 (47.2)
Change learning, teaching or assessment practice	160 (63.7)	91 (57.2)	13 (43.3)	116 (60.4)	9 (17.0)
Provide resources or implementation capacity	72 (28.7)	42 (26.4)	17 (56.7)	90 (46.9)	30 (56.6)
Set rules, safeguards or restrictions	41 (16.3)	80 (50.3)	4 (13.3)	25 (13.0)	5 (9.4)
Establish coordination or partnerships	16 (6.4)	11 (6.9)	3 (10.0)	38 (19.8)	13 (24.5)
Evaluate the AI intervention	9 (3.6)	5 (3.1)	3 (10.0)	10 (5.2)	0 (0.0)
No assigned substantive code	52 (20.7)	29 (18.2)	4 (13.3)	11 (5.7)	5 (9.4)
Action responsibility					
Public authorities	20 (8.0)	34 (21.4)	2 (6.7)	25 (13.0)	19 (35.8)
Educational organisations	47 (18.7)	57 (35.8)	14 (46.7)	93 (48.4)	27 (50.9)
Education and research workers	86 (34.3)	66 (41.5)	6 (20.0)	44 (22.9)	3 (5.7)
Learners	95 (37.8)	37 (23.3)	5 (16.7)	49 (25.5)	6 (11.3)
Families and caregivers	12 (4.8)	3 (1.9)	1 (3.3)	5 (2.6)	2 (3.8)
Commercial actors	32 (12.7)	14 (8.8)	5 (16.7)	26 (13.5)	16 (30.2)
Civic or international collectives	5 (2.0)	0 (0.0)	1 (3.3)	6 (3.1)	1 (1.9)
No assigned substantive code	69 (27.5)	42 (26.4)	7 (23.3)	31 (16.1)	6 (11.3)

Appendix B. Sensitivity of selected outlet comparisons

These checks retain the main sample and existing coding. Primary-only comparison counts the account already designated primary in each article. Single-outlet omission repeats the full article-presence comparison after removing each outlet in turn. The table reports public/central minus commercial/general percentage-point differences; omission ranges are descriptive ranges, not confidence intervals.

Table 10: Selected outlet differences under primary-only aggregation and outlet omission (percentage points).

Category	All accounts	Primary only	Omit one outlet
AI as a Driver of National Development	+12.6	+6.5	+10.8 to +13.5
Generative AI	-3.9	-5.8	-5.6 to -2.1
Undesirable	-9.3	-2.9	-11.0 to -6.8
Set rules, safeguards or restrictions	+10.7	+6.0	+9.7 to +11.5
Evaluate the AI intervention	+9.0	+4.4	+5.7 to +10.0

Negative evaluations appeared in 8.3% of public/central and 11.1% of commercial/general articles when only primary accounts were counted. The group difference was therefore smaller than for presence anywhere in an article. This distinction separates the inclusion of a negative account from its designation as the principal future arrangement; positively evaluated critical alternatives can still occupy that primary position.